



# RemoteAbility CIC

**RemoteAbility CIC 2025–2026**

*Empowering ability, everywhere.*

## **Executive Summary**

RemoteAbility CIC is a UK-based social enterprise on a mission to close the country's widening disability employment gap — now standing at 29.2 percentage points. We're building a future where disabled people can work, learn, and grow from home with dignity, flexibility, and fair opportunity.

The organisation exists because far too many talented individuals remain excluded from the modern workforce simply because their needs are not understood, their potential overlooked, or their environments inaccessible. RemoteAbility changes that by removing barriers, building digital skills, and connecting people to real, income-generating work that fits their lives.

Our approach is not theoretical — it's rooted in lived experience. Many of our team have faced these same obstacles, so our systems are designed with empathy, accessibility, and sustainability at their core. We combine human-centred support with technology and practical training to help each participant move from unemployment to meaningful, flexible work within months rather than years.

We do this through our structured four-phase programme — *Set Up & Outreach*, *Equip & Enable*, *Train & Deploy*, and *Scale & Progression* — a complete pathway that ensures every participant has the tools, confidence, and opportunity to succeed.

By helping each trainee secure the government's Access to Work grant (worth up to £69,260 per person annually), we remove financial and equipment barriers. We then guide them through accessible, real-world training and connect them to paid remote work placements through our partner network.

RemoteAbility isn't just a training provider — it's a new model for inclusive digital employment. It's designed to empower people, deliver measurable social value, and create a replicable blueprint that local councils, charities, and employers can adopt nationwide.

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## **Company Registration & Legal Status**

RemoteAbility CIC — Registered in England & Wales

**Company Number:** 16817651

**Date of Incorporation:** 29 October 2025

RemoteAbility CIC operates as a *Community Interest Company Limited by Guarantee*, regulated by the Office of the Regulator of Community Interest Companies. Its Asset Lock ensures that all profits are reinvested into social impact, not distributed to private shareholders.

This legal structure guarantees that every decision we make serves our community rather than private gain. It gives funders and partners confidence that their support directly advances equality, accessibility, and long-term employment outcomes for disabled people across the UK.

## **The Problem**

Across the UK, around 8.9 million working-age people live with a disability, yet only 53.3% are in employment compared to 82.5% of non-disabled people. That's a gap of nearly 30 percentage points — one of the widest in Europe. Despite years of initiatives and policy commitments, the disability employment gap has barely shifted.

This divide stems from deep-rooted barriers: inaccessible workplaces, limited remote work opportunities, and a benefits system that unintentionally discourages people from re-entering the workforce. Many face the cruel choice between stability and opportunity, fearing that taking a chance on work could result in the loss of vital financial support.

At the same time, a digital skills gap leaves thousands excluded from emerging industries such as technology, sales, data, and remote customer support. Even when opportunities exist, confidence and connection are often missing — particularly after long periods of unemployment or isolation.

The result is an enormous waste of human potential. Millions want to contribute but lack a fair route to do so. RemoteAbility exists to bridge that gap permanently — turning lived experience into leadership and frustration into meaningful work.

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## **Where RemoteAbility CIC Steps In**

RemoteAbility CIC provides the infrastructure, training, and partnerships that make remote work genuinely accessible. We operate at the intersection of social value and economic growth — demonstrating that inclusion is not a charity exercise but a competitive advantage.

Our model focuses on empowerment, not dependency. Each participant progresses through a supported learning and work pathway that builds technical capability, confidence, and financial independence. Employers benefit from a trained, motivated workforce that reflects the diversity of the communities they serve.

In essence, we give disabled people the tools to thrive in the digital economy while helping organisations meet their social value and inclusion goals.

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## **Our Solution: The RemoteAbility Model**

RemoteAbility CIC gives disabled people a clear, supported path from long-term unemployment to genuine career stability — all built around flexibility, dignity, and real opportunity.

Our approach is structured around four practical phases that repeat in every region, creating a proven system that turns inclusion into independence.

## **Phase 1 — Set Up & Outreach**

### **Laying the foundations for accessibility, growth, and trust**

We begin by creating the systems and partnerships that help people succeed again and again. This involves building the right digital infrastructure, connecting with local partners, and designing a transparent referral pathway from initial outreach to paid work.

#### **What we do**

Inclusive referrals are at the heart of our model. We collaborate with disability charities, local councils, training providers, and Jobcentres to identify people who want to work from home but need flexible roles. Each referral is handled personally, ensuring every participant receives the right support from day one.

We then establish secure remote systems for communication, data storage, and learning — designed for accessibility, privacy, and compliance. All materials are created in plain English, compatible with screen readers, and supported by subtitles or captions.

Confidence-building begins early, using micro-tasks, group calls, and peer sessions to rebuild trust and momentum.

#### **Result:**

A connected, reliable training and employment network that can be replicated in every region, supported by community partnerships and inclusive digital systems.

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## **Phase 2 — Equip & Enable**

### **Removing the barriers that stop people from even getting started**

Many people never begin training because they simply lack the equipment, funding, or confidence to start. We remove that obstacle completely.

Before any formal training begins, we help each participant apply for the government's Access to Work grant — worth up to £69,260 per person annually. This covers essential equipment, coaching, assistive software, and adjustments.

In addition, we work with technology companies and equipment suppliers who donate or reduce the cost of laptops, headsets, webcams, adjustable desks, and accessibility software. We also carry out home-working risk assessments to ensure safety, comfort, and wellbeing.

Through this stage, no one is left behind because of financial or environmental limitations. Everyone begins on equal footing — equipped, confident, and ready to learn.

#### **Result:**

Each participant enters training fully prepared, with the right tools, environment, and support to succeed.

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## **Phase 3 — Train & Deploy**

### **Turning potential into proof — through real work, not simulations**

This is where theory meets practice. Our training is practical, immersive, and designed to replicate real working conditions. Participants spend four to six weeks learning communication, sales, and client-support skills while working on live campaigns for partner companies such as Heimdell Tech AI and other inclusive employers.

Trainees earn commission on genuine leads and calls, meaning they experience the connection between effort, learning, and income from the very start. Alongside technical training, we provide daily coaching, role-play sessions, and wellbeing check-ins to build confidence and resilience.

Accessibility runs through every aspect of delivery. All content is captioned, formatted in easy-read styles, and compatible with assistive technology. Trainers adapt pacing to suit different learning styles, ensuring everyone can participate equally.

#### **Result:**

Graduates leave with tangible evidence of ability, real earnings, and the confidence that comes from doing the job — not just learning about it.

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## **Phase 4 — Scale & Progression**

### **From first earnings to lasting careers**

The journey doesn't end when the training does. We continue supporting graduates as they transition into long-term employment or freelance work. Some join our partner companies in part-time or full-time roles; others continue working independently with our mentorship and wellbeing support.

For those who want to grow further, we offer advanced modules in areas such as data protection, digital compliance, accessibility consultancy, and customer management. This ensures progression into higher-skilled, better-paid roles over time.

Employers benefit by accessing a pipeline of trained, reliable, home-based UK talent that strengthens their own diversity and social value commitments.

#### **Result:**

A self-sustaining community of skilled remote professionals who not only succeed individually but mentor the next generation — creating a cycle of empowerment and inclusion that scales naturally.

## **Our First-Year Goal**

To support **100 disabled people** into paid remote work within our first year, then expand regionally each year thereafter. By doing so, we aim to prove that accessible, flexible work can become a cornerstone of the UK's future economy.

### **Get Involved**

**Employers:** Hire trained remote workers and access a dedicated, supported workforce.

**Tech partners:** Donate or discount accessible equipment and software to remove barriers.

**Charities & councils:** Refer participants and collaborate on outreach, funding, and shared outcomes.

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## **Partnership Ecosystem (2025 Launch)**

RemoteAbility CIC is powered by collaboration.

- **Heimdell Tech AI** – Technology partner providing CRM automation, AI workflow tools, and training integration.
- **Local Authorities (Preston, Lancashire, Blackpool)** – Pilot employment partners supporting Access to Work delivery and Levelling Up objectives.
- **Training Providers & Colleges** – Regional partners offering blended training and employment support.
- **Charity & DPO Network** – Organisations such as Scope, Disability Positive, and Leonard Cheshire, helping to identify and support participants.

Together, these relationships form an inclusive ecosystem that bridges policy with practice — ensuring that people, not systems, stay at the heart of employment innovation.

## Year-One Financial Overview (2025–2026 Launch Phase)

| Category                         | Purpose                                              | Estimated Cost  | Funding Source                         |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------|
| Trainee onboarding & induction   | Screening, onboarding, welcome packs                 | £15,000         | Grants / CIC reserves                  |
| Equipment & accessibility        | 25 trainees @ £2,000 each (laptops, desks, software) | £50,000         | <b>Access to Work</b> reimbursements   |
| CRM, VoIP & IT infrastructure    | Secure communication tools (via Heimdell Tech AI)    | £8,000          | In-kind / partner contribution         |
| Training delivery & job coaching | Course design, trainers, mentors                     | £25,000         | Launch grant / Local council           |
| Marketing & outreach             | Recruitment campaigns, council engagement            | £5,000          | CIC reserves                           |
| Legal, insurance & compliance    | Incorporation, GDPR, safeguarding cover              | £2,000          | CIC reserves                           |
| <b>Total Year-One Budget</b>     |                                                      | <b>£105,000</b> | ~70% grants & AtW / 30% trading income |

These projections demonstrate sustainability and scalability. Because equipment and accessibility support are funded via Access to Work, operational risk remains low and long-term expansion becomes achievable with modest additional funding.

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## Governance Framework

RemoteAbility CIC is governed under its *Governance Policy (2025)* and operates transparently as a Community Interest Company Limited by Guarantee.

### **Board of Directors (2025):**

- **Ld. Thomas Oliver Matthews** — Chair & Co-Founder
- **Andrew James-Smith** — Managing Director
- **Phillip Burton** — Operations Director

The Board ensures strategic direction, financial integrity, and compliance with UK legislation, including Safeguarding, Equality, Data Protection (GDPR 2018), and Health & Safety (1974).

The CIC's internal governance is reinforced by its full suite of organisational policies — Equality, Diversity & Inclusion; Accessibility & Adjustments; Safeguarding; Privacy & Confidentiality; and Health & Safety (Remote Work).

All directors sign an annual *Code of Conduct* to maintain accountability and uphold the organisation's asset-locked mission.

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### **Next Six Months — Operational Roadmap**

- **October–November 2025:** Finalise Companies House and HMRC setup; confirm operational bank accounts and insurance.
- **November–December 2025:** Submit funding applications to UnLtd, Key Fund, and the National Lottery Community Fund; initiate partner agreements.
- **January 2026:** Launch **Pilot Cohort #1** — 15–20 trainees via Access to Work and Heimdell Tech AI.
- **February–April 2026:** Begin **Employer Outreach Campaign** targeting councils, SMEs, and social value supply chains.
- **March 2026:** Publish Year-One Impact Dashboard and draft CIC34 Report.
- **April–May 2026:** Prepare for **Regional Expansion Phase II**, replicating the model in two new local authorities.

This timeline positions RemoteAbility CIC for measurable, reportable impact by mid-2026 and sets the foundation for national scale in 2027.

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### **Building the Future, Together**

RemoteAbility CIC is not simply another training project — it's a proof of concept that accessibility and productivity can grow hand in hand. Every participant we train and every partnership we form brings the UK closer to a truly inclusive digital economy.

We invite funders, councils, employers, and technology partners to join us in building a national model for inclusive remote work. Together, we can replace exclusion with opportunity and isolation with achievement — proving that when everyone can contribute, everyone benefits.

